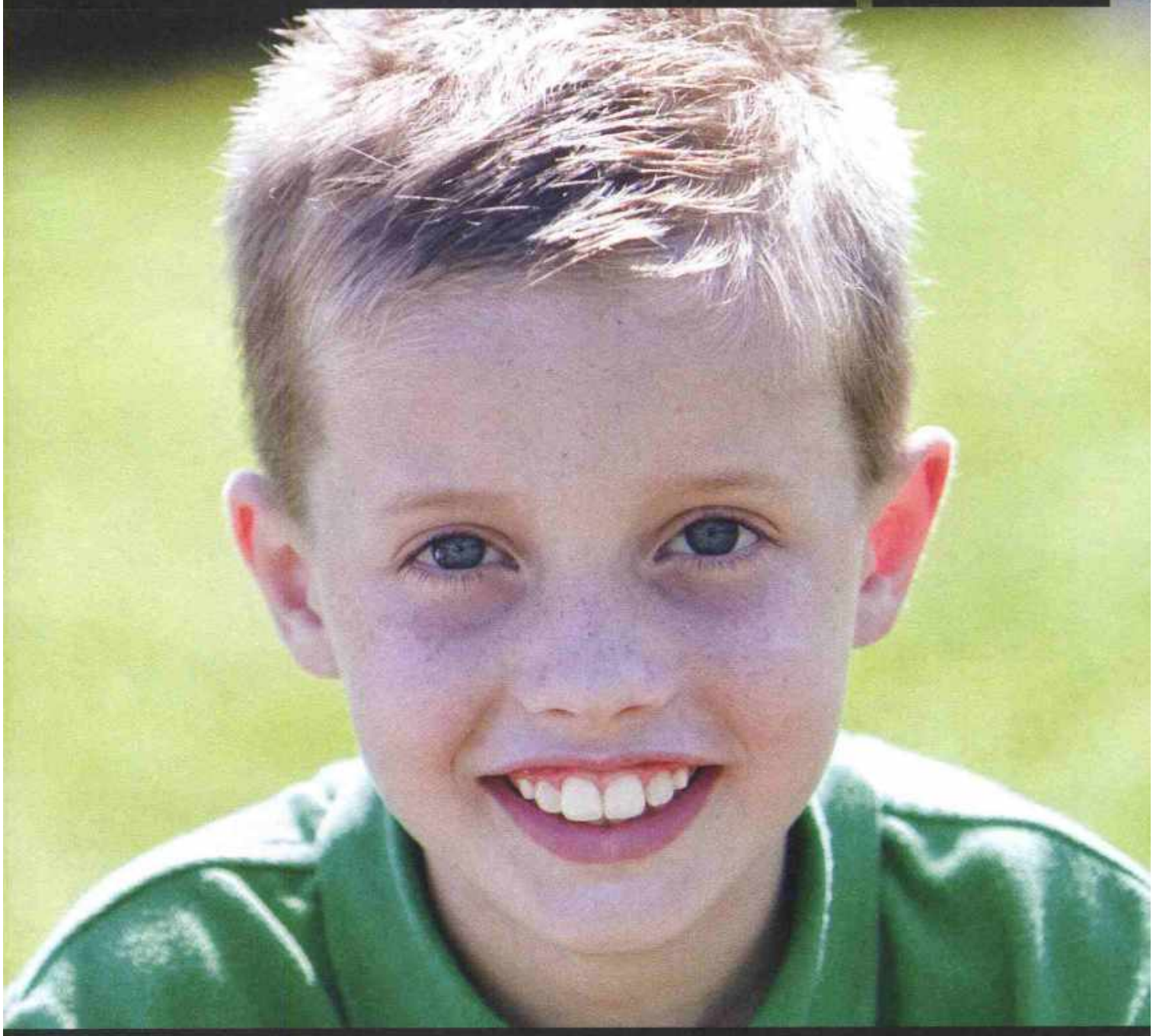
YOUR MAGAZINE FROM GALLIONS

thamesview

NEWS • EVENTS • COMPETITIONS

APRIL 2012
www.gallionsha.co.uk



THREE WAYS TO GET INVOLVED

THAMESMEAD IN BLOOM IS BACK

PLANNED MAINTENANCE UPDATE

Gallions Housing Association

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COMPLETE OUR SURVEY: £30 VOUCHER TO BE WON!

WELCOME

'It's good to talk' so that's why we've included a short survey with this edition. We'd really appreciate it if you could fill it in and tell us what you think of this magazine. There will be a £30 voucher up for grabs for one lucky respondent too.

In this edition we have lots of ways to keep busy now the weather is warmer, including arranging your very own Big Lunch to celebrate the Queen's Diamond Jubilee and taking part in our gardening competition.

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Gallions Residents Group

Gallions Housing Association



DIGITAL SWITCHOVER: WHAT TO DO NEXT

This month the analogue TV signal will be switched off in London and replaced with a new, stronger digital signal. To keep watching TV you should already have converted the TVs in your home by getting a digital box.

You will need to re-tune your digital equipment twice this month to pick up all the available channels. The first re-tune date was 4 April and the next re-tune date is 18 April.

For more information and re-tune guides visit www.digitaluk.co.uk or call 08456 50 50 50.

If you are disabled or elderly extra support is available from the Digital UK Team.

THAMESMEAD IN BLOOM IS BACK!



This summer The Friends of Thamesmead Parks, supported by Gallions will be running a gardening competition to help celebrate the green fingered folk of Thamesmead.

We will be offering residents the chance to nominate a neighbour or friend to win some great prizes for their beautiful garden, balcony or communal space.

Contact Kelly Sullivan on 0300 123 1237, email ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk or visit our website for a nomination form.

BIG LOVELY LUNCH!



Get together with your neighbours

In 2011 two million people took part in The Big Lunch across the UK and this year it's set to be bigger than ever! The event will take place on Sunday 3 June 2012 as part of the Queen's Diamond Jubilee holiday so it's a perfect time to get to know your neighbours.

Whether you fancy running a small afternoon tea or a big community party there's plenty of help available. Visit www.thebiglunch.com or call 0845 850 8181 for a free pack that contains everything you need to get started; from a step by step planning guide to posters and invitations.

Remember you'll need to check with your local council (or landowner) if you want to close a road or use a public park near you.



LOCAL TO YOU
LOCAL FOR YOU

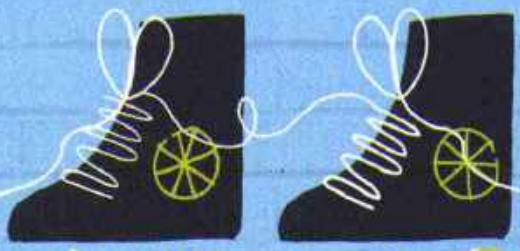
sportingclubthamesmead.co.uk

All sports and fitness activities at Sporting Club Thamesmead are being delivered in partnership with external companies and organisations. These include: Trust Thamesmead, Charlton Athletic Community Trust, Thamesmead Town Football Club and 6-a-side.co.uk

Brand new community sports & leisure club
Open to everyone
Reasonable prices
No joining fees
Sky Sports

Sporting Club Thamesmead
Healthier together

the LINK



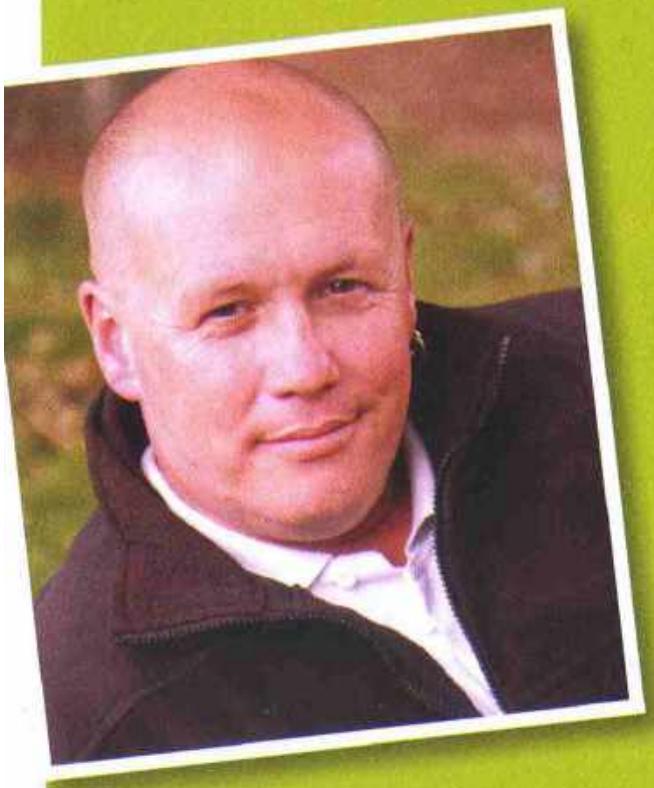
MAKE A connection

nyplace

TRUST. THAMESMEAD

Thamesmead has a new community hub where you can connect with all kinds of people and all sorts of opportunities from the arts, to fitness and even further education.
Make your connection at: **thelinkthamesmead.co.uk**

MEET A NEIGHBOURHOOD WARDEN



We have a team of four Wardens who patrol our communities, run neighbourhood inspections and generally help to resolve any issues residents have in their area.

The team has recently achieved a pass in the BTEC Professional Award in Community Safety, Crime & Nuisance Management, so they are real experts in what they do too!

Here we meet Chris, one of the wardens who has lived in Thamesmead for 23 years and works with our residents in Thamesmead and east London. He is also a keen photographer.

What do you like most about your job?
I get to talk to residents and I really like the social aspect of the role. I enjoy getting good results for residents and helping to improve where they live too.

Can you describe your typical day?
Every day is different and we never know what will happen! We run regular neighbourhood inspections for residents, meet with the police to help tackle problems with anti-social behaviour, monitor our CCTV cameras and deal with any emergencies that come up.

Do you enjoy working in east London?
Working in Tower Hamlets and Newham is a new challenge for me. In Thamesmead our residents are used to seeing us and our vans but I've had to work a bit harder to build relationships with residents in new areas.

If you had one piece of advice for residents what would it be?
To go out and visit the great parks, lakes and open spaces in their areas. They should take a camera too!

THE OLYMPICS ARE COMING

This summer the Olympic Games will arrive in London. The events will run from 27 July - 12 August and 29 August - 9 September. During this time there will be a number of road closures across London and increased numbers of people using public transport.

We will publish information about how we plan to minimise disruption to our services in the July issue of Thamesview, once more details are confirmed by the Olympic Committee.

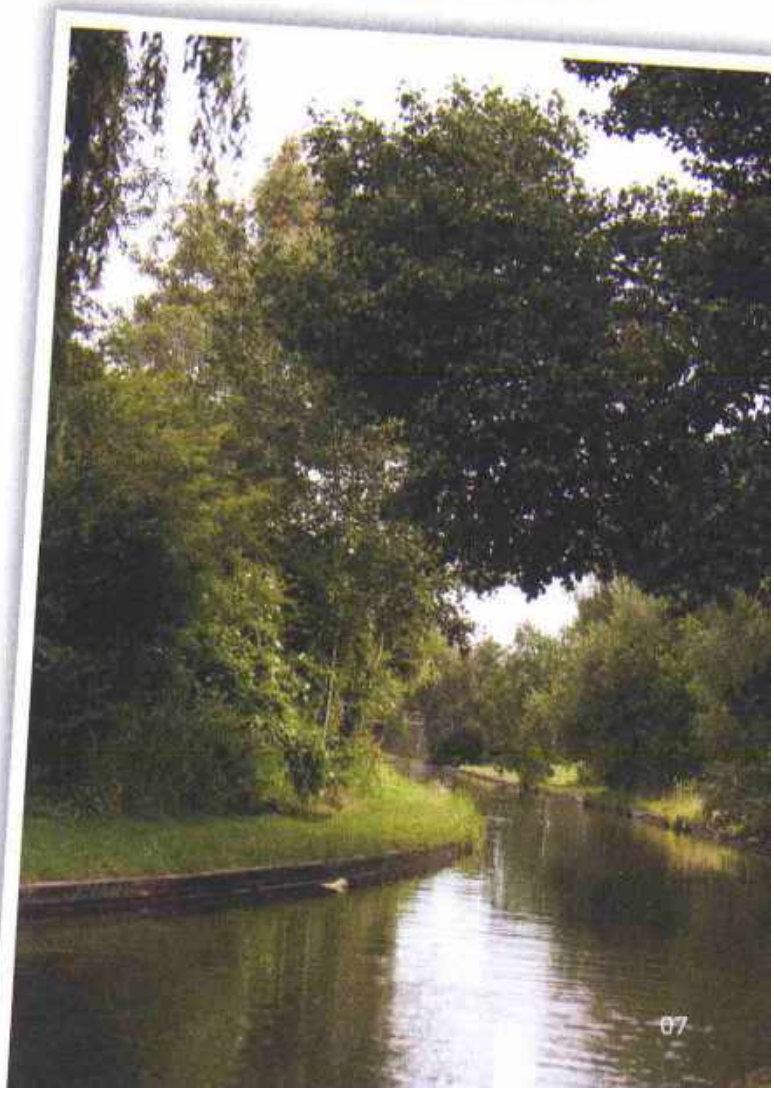
For travel information visit www.tfl.gov.uk/2012 or www.getaheadofthegames.com.

You can also call 0845 267 2012 for general enquiries about the Olympics.

LOCAL VOLUNTEERS NEEDED!

- DO YOU USE THE LAKES AND CANALS IN THAMESMEAD?
- WOULD YOU LIKE TO MEET NEW PEOPLE?
- ARE YOU A FAN OF THE GREAT OUTDOORS?

Then why not volunteer some of your time to help maintain and improve the canals, lakes and towpaths in Thamesmead. Everyone is welcome. All you need is spare time, enthusiasm and some old clothes you don't mind getting dirty. We will supply the equipment you need and help you get started on the day. Please contacted Solomon Small on 0300 123 1237 or email ssmall@gallionsha.co.uk for more information.





Three ways to get involved

There are lots of opportunities for you to get involved with us and help improve services for all residents. We are looking for new members for Gallions Residents Group, The Customer Services Committee and Gallions Strategic Board:

Gallions Residents Group

Gallions Residents Group (GRG) is a scrutiny panel that looks at our performance and resident feedback to help make sure we are meeting regulatory standards.

The group makes recommendations for service improvement and has direct links to Gallions Customer Services Committee and Board.

There are approximately eight evening meetings per year and members are also asked to attend training events and additional meetings as required.

GRG membership is a big commitment and members receive £1000 per year in shopping vouchers plus travel expenses. Applicants will be shortlisted and interviewed against set criteria. The deadline for completed applications is 29 June 2012. For more information and an application pack contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk.

Customer Services Committee

This committee looks at how Gallions works on an operational level and reviews how well Gallions performs in different service areas. Members monitor the progress of the suggestions and actions from the Gallions Resident Group.



Applicants would be expected to volunteer around six days a year as part of the Customer Service Committee.

Gallions Strategic Board

Gallions Residents' Group and Gallions Housing Association are currently looking for expressions of interest from tenants, leaseholders and charge payers who would like to represent residents in the management of Gallions on the Gallions Housing Association Limited Strategic Board.

The successful candidates will provide a direct link between residents and the Board and will bring a resident's perspective to strategic decision making. Full training is provided.

This is a great opportunity to get involved with Gallions and really make a difference in your local community. This is a paid role of £5000 per annum plus reasonable expenses and it is anticipated the role will require a commitment of approximately 12 days per year.

The application process

All applications for the Customer Services Committee and Gallions Strategic Board are assessed and a shortlist created. If you are shortlisted you will be evaluated against a competency based selection process and interviewed by a panel that includes Gallions Resident Group members.

The deadline for completed applications for both roles is 29 June 2012. For more information and an application pack contact Jane Lester on 0300 123 1237 or email jlester@gallionsha.co.uk

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

VIRGIN LONDON MARATHON

STARTS AT GREENWICH PARK

22 April >> www.virginlondonmarathon.com >> 020 7902 0200

A PLACE TO CALL HOME EXHIBITION

(INCLUDING A FEATURE ON THAMESMEAD)

Royal Institute of British Architects >> 66 Portland Place >> London

Until 28 April | 10am - 5pm >> Free

www.architecture.com >> 020 7307 3694

QUEEN'S DIAMOND JUBILEE WEEKEND

THROUGHOUT LONDON

2 - 5 June >> www.thediamondjubilee.org >> 020 7930 4832

CHARLTON HOUSE SUMMER FAYRE

CHARLTON

24 June >> 11am - 4pm >> Free

www.charlton-house.org >> 020 8856 3951

Q	N	W	R	E	T	R	R	A	H	Y	T	U
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D	A	F	O	G	D	Y	E	N	D	Y	S	O
S	P	A	N	Z	M	X	Q	C	E	V	F	B

WIN WITH OUR WORDSEARCH

In this wordsearch we have hidden the names of six countries that have previously hosted the summer Olympics. Find them all and you could win a £30 shopping voucher.

SEOUL ✓
BEIJING ✓
ATLANTA ✓
✓ **SYDNEY**
✓ **BARCELONA**
✓ **ATHENS**

DID YOU KNOW...

Athens was the host city of the first modern-day Olympic Games in 1896, and 108 years later it welcomed home the 2004 Summer Olympics. Athens is one of the world's oldest cities, as its recorded history spans around 3,400 years.

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Glover, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 11 May 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

Telephone: .....

Email: .....

Congratulations to Peter Warr of Poplar Place who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Tenants view...

With the Diamond Jubilee and the Olympics just around the corner, the GRG is looking forward to the community celebrations that will be taking place. From street parties and local events to the Thames Diamond Jubilee Pageant and the Olympic Opening Ceremony there will be lots of activities to get involved with and spectacles to see. Let's hope we pick up a few gold medals too!



The big Olympic debate!

The Olympics is almost here and there are mixed views about how the Games will affect our daily routines. Here are just a few examples of what some residents have been telling us:

- "I can't wait for the excitement and buzz of the Games."
- "The preparation for the Games has gone over budget."
- "It's great to be part of such an historic event."
- "There could be lots of travel disruption."
- "It'll introduce some fun back to Britain in the difficult economic climate."
- "Not everyone is interested in sport."
- "The Games will bring increased tourism "
- "Most of the activities are in London - what about other parts of Britain?"
- "There have been lots of employment and volunteering opportunities created."
- "No other country has made a profit from the Olympics."

Whatever your feelings we hope that you can enjoy some element of the summer's activities. Gallions' offices will be open as usual during the games but they will keep you informed if they need to change any of their services. Visit www.london2012.com or call 0845 267 2012 for more information about the games.

A recipe to share



Why not make this delicious treat and take it along to a Diamond Jubilee celebration near you to share with your neighbours.

APPLE CRUMBLE CAKE

Preparation time: 25 minutes.
Cooking time: 40 minutes to 45 minutes
Total time: 1 hour to 1 hour 5 minutes
Makes: 8 slices - Easy

INGREDIENTS

Crumble topping

25g Oats
25g Self Raising Flour
40g Caster Sugar
40g Butter
1 tsp Ground Cinnamon

Fruit Filling

2 Eating Apples
(Whatever is in season)
1 tsp Ground Cinnamon
1 tsp Caster Sugar
1tbsp Lemon Juice

Sponge

2 medium eggs
100g caster sugar
100ml Sunflower Oil
100g self-raising flour

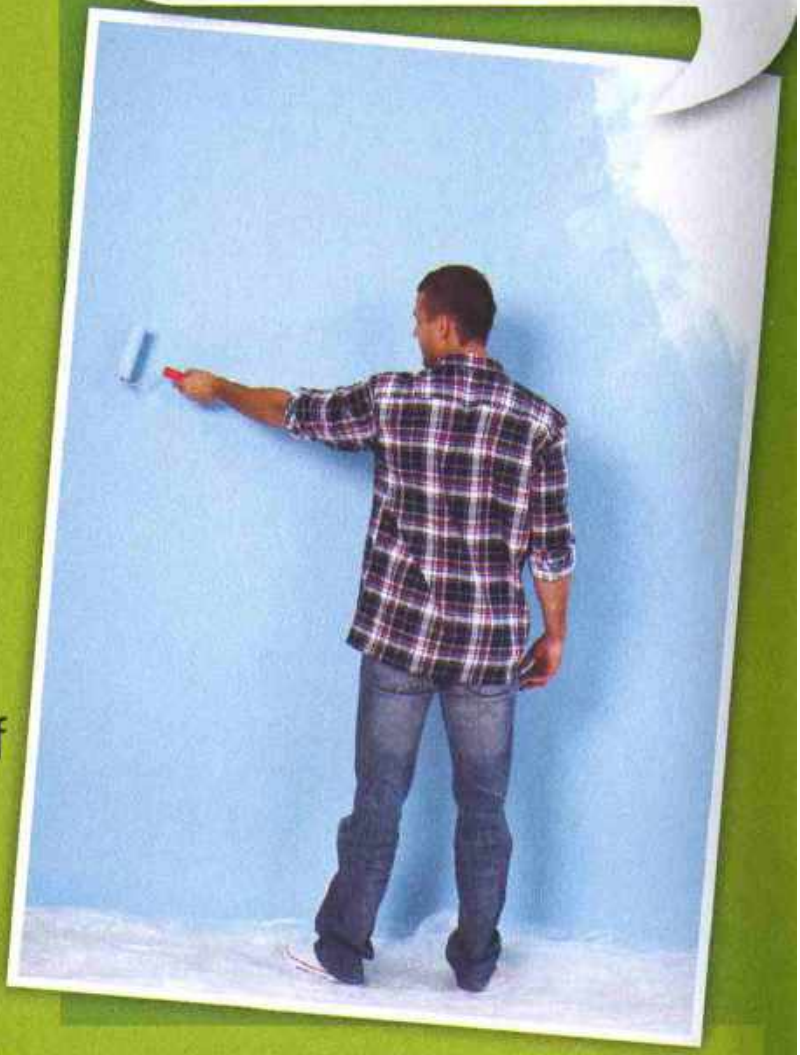
METHOD

1. Preheat the oven to 180°C, gas mark 4. Grease and line the base of a 23cm round, cake tin.
2. Peel, core and thinly slice the apples, toss in the tsp of cinnamon, lemon juice and sugar and set aside.
3. To make the crumble topping, measure the crumble topping ingredients together into a bowl. Add the cinnamon and rub everything together with your fingertips until it forms a rough crumble, set aside.
4. For the sponge, put the sugar and the eggs in a large bowl and use an electric whisk to mix together. Whisk for about 10 minutes until the mixture is pale and thick, and leaves a trail on the surface when the whisk blades are lifted, Pour in the oil, folding it in carefully to preserve as much air as possible. Sieve the flour over the top and fold in.
5. Turn the mixture into the cake tin and scatter the apple slices evenly over the top, then pour over any liquid that has accumulated in the container. Sprinkle the crumble over and bake for 40-45 minutes, until the cake is firm to the touch and golden brown. Allow to cool for 10 minutes in the tin before turning out. Enjoy!

Tenants view...

Need a hand at home?

Now that spring is here it's a great time to tackle those DIY jobs at home but if you're elderly or disabled this can be a bit of a challenge. There are a number of services that can help:



- Gallions - Ask about minor adaptations in your home, like extra handrails. They can give advice about services for vulnerable residents. Call 0300 123 1237
- Your local council - Speak to them about a Disabled Facilities Grant or major adaptations at home. They may also have their own handyperson service
- Age UK HandyVan Service - Age UK have a handyperson service in some areas. Visit www.ageuk.org.uk or call 0800 169 65 65
- Charities - There are a number of charities that can help, depending on your circumstances. Visit www.turn2us.org.uk or call 020 8834 9200
- Home Improvement Agencies - These agencies can help homeowners to repair and improve their homes. Visit www.foundations.uk.com or call 0845 8645210

Resident engagement update



Gallions Residents Group has been working hard in their new role as a scrutiny group. This means that they look objectively at Gallions' services and make recommendations for improvement to senior managers and the Customer Services Committee.

The group has recently looked at the customer experience of reporting repairs and has put together a report that will be reviewed by managers and used to change services.

After a really successful Taster Day, Gallions recruited more Resident Auditors who will be auditing the communal cleaning and maintenance work in public areas soon.

If you would like to get involved with Gallions contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk.

New members wanted!

Tavy Bridge Regeneration Resident's Action Group (TBRRAG) has been active since 2004, organising social events like the Big Lunch and influencing the progress of the regeneration project in the area.



With work starting on phase three shortly there's never been a more important time to get involved. The group is looking for new members and would like to invite local residents to join them at any of their meetings.

The group meets on the last Monday of each month at the One Stop Shop on Tavy Bridge at 7:00 pm. The next meeting will be on Monday 30 April 2012.

This year TBRRAG will be holding their Jubilee Big Lunch in Southmere Park. Bring your lunch and join them for a chat. For further information please contact Cherry Kent, Chair of TBRRAG on 07930 314525 or email cherrykent@hotmail.co.uk.

SCAFFOLDING

"The safety of our residents, staff and visitors is very important to us"

We sometimes have to install scaffolding when we carry out repairs and maintenance work in our properties. The safety of our residents, staff and visitors is very important to us so when we use scaffolding we will:

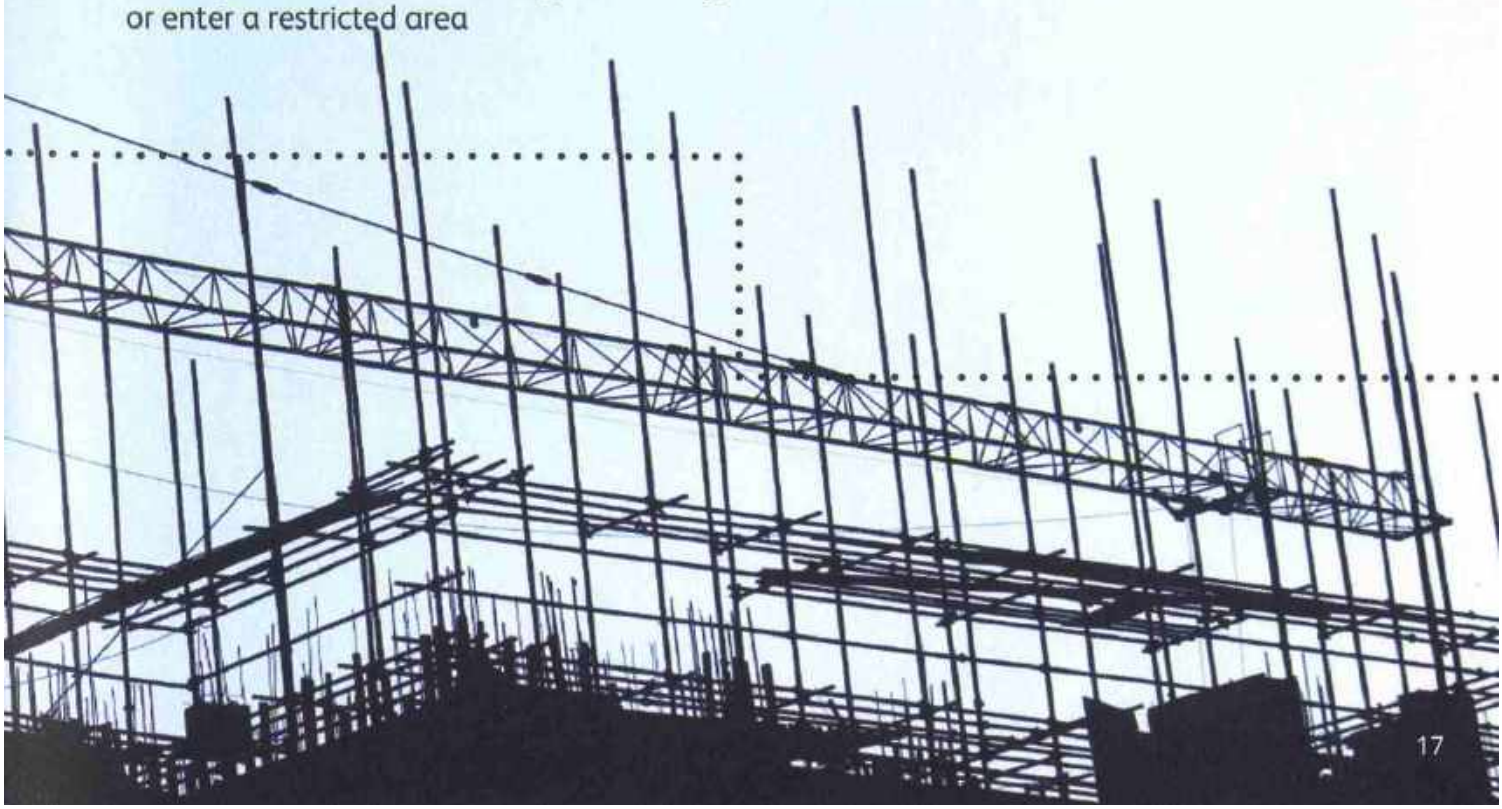
- Regularly inspect and maintain scaffolding equipment to reduce risks to you and your family
- Ensure that safe working practices are followed at all times
- Contact you if we feel that your access routes could be restricted
- Consider your home security and put in place effective safeguards
- Tell you about anticipated hours of work and try to restrict working hours to sociable times
- Investigate and act upon any unsafe working practices or complaints received in a timely manner



SAFETY

You should also take extra care when scaffolding is used where you live:

- **Don't** walk under or near the scaffold, unless absolutely necessary, as you may bang your head or could be hit by debris
- **Don't** tamper with the scaffolding by undoing any bolts/joints or by removing poles, scaffold boards or safety netting
- **Don't** leave your windows or doors open during working hours due to possible dust and noise whilst the work is being carried out on the scaffold
- **Don't** park vehicles close to scaffolding
- **Don't** climb up any ladders or use any mechanical lifts attached to the scaffolding; they are for use by the contractors only
- **Don't** allow children or young persons under your control to climb any scaffolding or enter a restricted area
- **Do** discuss safe access arrangements with the Tenant Liaison Officer from our contractor Axis or with a Gallions Surveyor; it may be necessary to restrict access in some cases
- **Do** lock your windows and doors for security purposes whilst the scaffold is erected as criminals have been known to use scaffolding to break into homes
- **Do** let us know if you are worried that scaffolding may affect things like decking or patio areas in your garden. These may need to be temporarily removed but we will discuss this with you in advance
- **Do** take very careful note of any safety notices and warning signs
- **Do** contact Gallions Asset Management Team on 0300 123 1237 or your Axis Tenant Liaison Officer immediately if you have any concerns about the safety or security of scaffolding and those using it



What a waste!



Recently there has been an increase in the amount of household waste which is being dumped in the Bexley and Greenwich areas. It costs Gallions around £200,000 each year to remove and dispose of the rubbish, which we would rather spend on community improvements.

Our Enforcement Team works in partnership with Councils to identify rubbish dumpers. We recently caught one resident dumping several boxes and they received an £80 fixed penalty fine plus £60 in costs. It's also a breach of your tenancy or lease to fly tip. We want our neighbourhoods to stay clean and safe for residents and visitors so please follow these tips to keep the area tidy:

- If you live in a flat with a waste disposal chute place the waste in a suitable bag; don't use large black bags as these often block the chutes
- Don't leave any items or bags on the landings of a block or on the street
- When using the Recycle Bins, place the correct items into the bins and do not leave any items next to the bins
- If you live in a house make sure you put your rubbish out on the correct day and in the right bins and boxes
- If you have a big item of refuse (e.g. sofa, TV) take it to the tip or call your local council to come and collect it. We also offer a free, bookable bulk waste collection to residents who live in flats. Call us on 0300 123 1237 and let us know what you would like collected

If you would like to tell us about someone who is dumping household waste in your area please contact us on 0300 123 1238. You can call anonymously if you prefer.

YOU SAID, WE DID

We regularly change what we do because of feedback from residents. Here are just some examples of when your ideas help to improve our service.

ITEM	PREVIOUS SITUATION	RESIDENT SUGGESTIONS	NEW SERVICES
Cookers	Our properties have a 45 amp supply and a gas connection for cookers	Residents told us some new style dual fuel or gas cookers require a 13 amp supply	We will now adapt the existing outlet as appropriate. There is clear information included in the welcome pack for new residents
Empty properties	Repairs and decoration to empty properties before new residents move in didn't include hallways	The Resident Inspectors told us some empty properties weren't very attractive to new residents	We now decorate hallways
Emails to Gallions	When residents emailed the enquiries @gallionsha.co.uk address they didn't get an automatic response	Residents told us they'd like to know that their enquiry was being dealt with	The email has been changed so an acknowledgement is given and the name of the person dealing with it is provided
Homeowner publications	Thamesview was sent to tenants, shared owners and leaseholders	The Homeowner Consultation Panel told us that charge-paying freeholders would also like to receive the magazine	We now send Thamesview magazine to tenants, shared owners, leaseholders and charge-paying freeholders

New services for residents

We have recently changed the structure of our neighbourhood services team so that we can improve services and have more staff available to help our new and current residents. We are also planning to open a new office for residents in Thamesmead town centre in the summer so many of you can pop in and see us more easily.

We are still recruiting for new members of staff and finalising the plans for the new office so we will publish more information in the coming months.

For more details check our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or call 0300 123 1237.

New Gas Contractor



We have just appointed a new contractor, P&R Installation, to carry out gas servicing and repairs work on the central heating systems in our properties. P&R work with lots of housing associations and councils in London and have an excellent customer service record. P&R started working with us this month so look out for their vans and workmen where you live. Remember to always check the ID of any unknown visitors at your door.

Southmere Village
Regeneration Project Update

We are now in the third phase of our Southmere Village regeneration project. We will be building 296 homes of different sizes for rent, shared ownership and private sale. In addition we'll be rebuilding the current library and providing four commercial units.

The project is due to start soon and will take around four years to complete – although we intend to finish the affordable homes by the end of March 2015.

We have been talking to local residents and the Tavy Bridge Regeneration Residents Action Group (TBRRAG) about our plans. We have also spoken to local councillors, the local MP and other stakeholders so by now everyone should have a better idea about what is happening in the area.

We want residents to have their say and influence the plans before we submit them to Bexley Council later this month. We are available at the One Stop Shop at Tavy Bridge on Tuesday mornings and Thursday afternoons if you would like to drop in and give us your views or ask any questions. We'll also be holding another formal consultation session shortly.

In the meantime, Kier has been selected as our contractor and they have started carrying out site surveys. This is on a block by block basis and will take a few weeks to complete. Once the surveys have been completed, demolition will start and we expect the first block to be demolished towards the end of May.

We will continue to keep everyone updated through regular newsletters, information on our website, the One Stop Shop and formal consultation events. If you would like to find out more please contact our Regeneration Team on 0300 123 1237.

Caught on camera

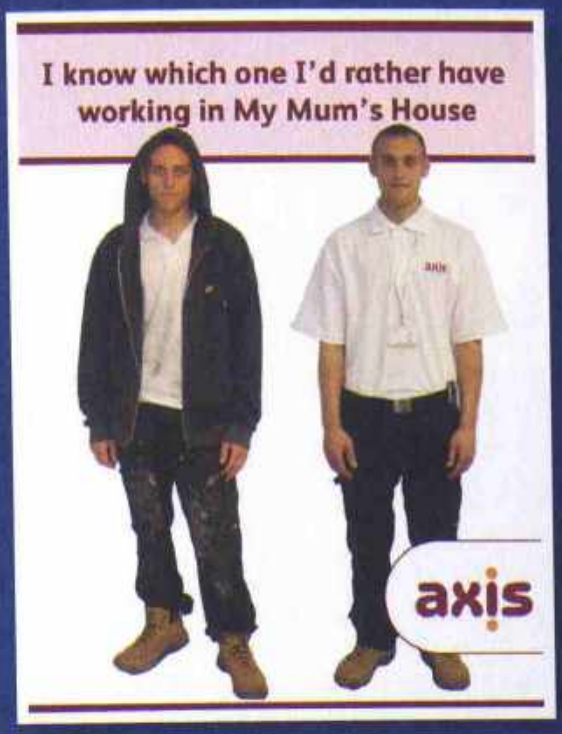


We have CCTV in our neighbourhoods to help protect our residents and properties. We use CCTV when we investigate reports of anti-social behaviour and provide the footage to the police when a crime has taken place.

Recently our CCTV images have been used as evidence in court and there have been two convictions as a result:

- The son of a tenant was arrested for stealing metal from the roof of Beveridge Court, Thamesmead. The CCTV images we provided were used as evidence and he was recently found guilty of the offence at Woolwich Crown Court and received three months imprisonment. Gallions will be serving a Notice of Seeking Possession against the tenant for breach of tenancy.
- Another tenant was identified committing robberies in the area. CCTV images were provided to police as evidence and the person pleaded guilty. He was recently sentenced at Woolwich Crown Court, where he received 3.5 years imprisonment. The tenancy has been ended.

If you witness a crime taking place always call 999. You can provide confidential information about criminal activities to Crimestoppers on 0800 555 111.



Our contractors, your home

When our contractors visit you at home to c out repairs or maintenance we ask them to follow certain guidelines. They are required

- Show you their identification
- Be polite and professional
- Tidy up after themselves
- Not smoke
- Aim to arrive on time or call you to let you know they are running late

Our main contractor Axis also has a 'My Mu House' policy, which asks workers to treat residents' homes like their mum's house. W working in your homes their operatives sho

- Wear a tidy uniform and shoe covers
- Explain the work before they start
- Use dust sheets or protective coverings as appropriate
- Keep you informed of progress
- Take rubbish away with them
- Let you know when the work is completed

If you would like to report a repair please c 0300 123 1238 or for non-urgent items vis www.gallionsha.co.uk.

Update on our planned maintenance programme

We published a new five year planned maintenance programme in 2011, which shows where we will be carrying out home improvements in the coming years. There have been minor delays to some work so far but we don't expect this to affect our overall plan.



During the last financial year we spent more than £7.5 million on a range of different maintenance work:

- New kitchens and bathrooms
- Electrical rewire programme
- Replacement windows & doors
- New roof coverings
- Replacement lifts
- Public area maintenance
- External improvements
- Works to prepare for the digital switchover

In the next year we aim to carry out repairs in the following areas:

NEW WINDOWS AND DOORS

- Bright Court
- Booth Close
- Chadwick Court
- Cobden Court
- Hazlitt Court
- Kingsley Court
- Lytton Strachey Path
- Manning Court
- Raymond Postgate Court
- Shaftesbury Court
- Wilberforce Court

REPLACEMENT ROOFS

- Bright Court
- Chadwick Court
- Cobden Court
- Hazlitt Court
- Hammond way
- Kingsley Court
- Lytton Strachey Path
- Manning Court
- Raymond Postgate Court
- Ricardo Path
- Rowntree path
- Shaftesbury Court
- Wilberforce Court
- Booth Close



REPLACEMENT OF MAIN BLOCK ENTRANCE DOORS AND DOOR ENTRY SYSTEMS

- Keynes Court
- Webb Court
- Raymond Postgate Court
- Curtis Way
- Tawney Road
- Lansbury Court
- Beveridge Court
- Hammond Way

LIFT REPLACEMENTS

- Jacob House
- Clydesdale House
- Oakenholt House

BLOCK RE-WIRING AND INSTALLATION OF EMERGENCY LIGHTING

- Osney House
- Penton House
- Oakenholt House
- Trewsbury House

We will also carry out further repairs to bridges and footpaths and continue to improve spaces outside your home like bin areas and parking.

If you would like a copy of our full five year programme, download it from our website or pick one up from our office in Titmuss Avenue.

LAMINATE AND WOOD FLOORING

Before you consider installing laminate or wood flooring you should check your lease or tenancy agreement and contact your Housing Officer to see if these floor types are permitted.

If you live in a flat, laminate and wood flooring really increases the levels of noise for those living below you. In some cases the noise can be very loud and can affect the health and well being of your neighbours so it's really important to install underlay with wood flooring. Underlay will also help your flooring last longer and reduce injury if someone falls over at home.

If you experience noise problems, chatting to your neighbours is usually the best way to make them aware of the issue and to reduce problems in future. If you don't feel you can approach your neighbour directly, let us know on 0300 123 1237 so that we can arrange to speak to them on your behalf.

If you install such flooring without the appropriate permission, you may be asked to remove it and fit carpets at your expense. Persistent noise nuisance may also result in action being taken for breach of tenancy.

"CHECK YOUR LEASE OR TENANCY AGREEMENT AND CONTACT YOUR HOUSING OFFICER TO SEE IF THESE FLOOR TYPES ARE PERMITTED."

NOISE FROM DIFFERENT FLOOR TYPES

Worse



- Bare floor
- Laminate with no underlay
- Laminate with standard underlay
- Laminate with specialist underlay
- Foam backed vinyl
- Carpet
- Carpet with underlay

Better

HOMEOWNER NEWS

New regulations for gas flues

Some properties, mainly flats and apartments, have been built with boiler flues which are hidden behind walls or ceilings.

New regulations say that Gas Safe engineers need to be able to see the flue - which takes fumes away from the boiler - as part of essential safety checks whenever the boiler is worked on.



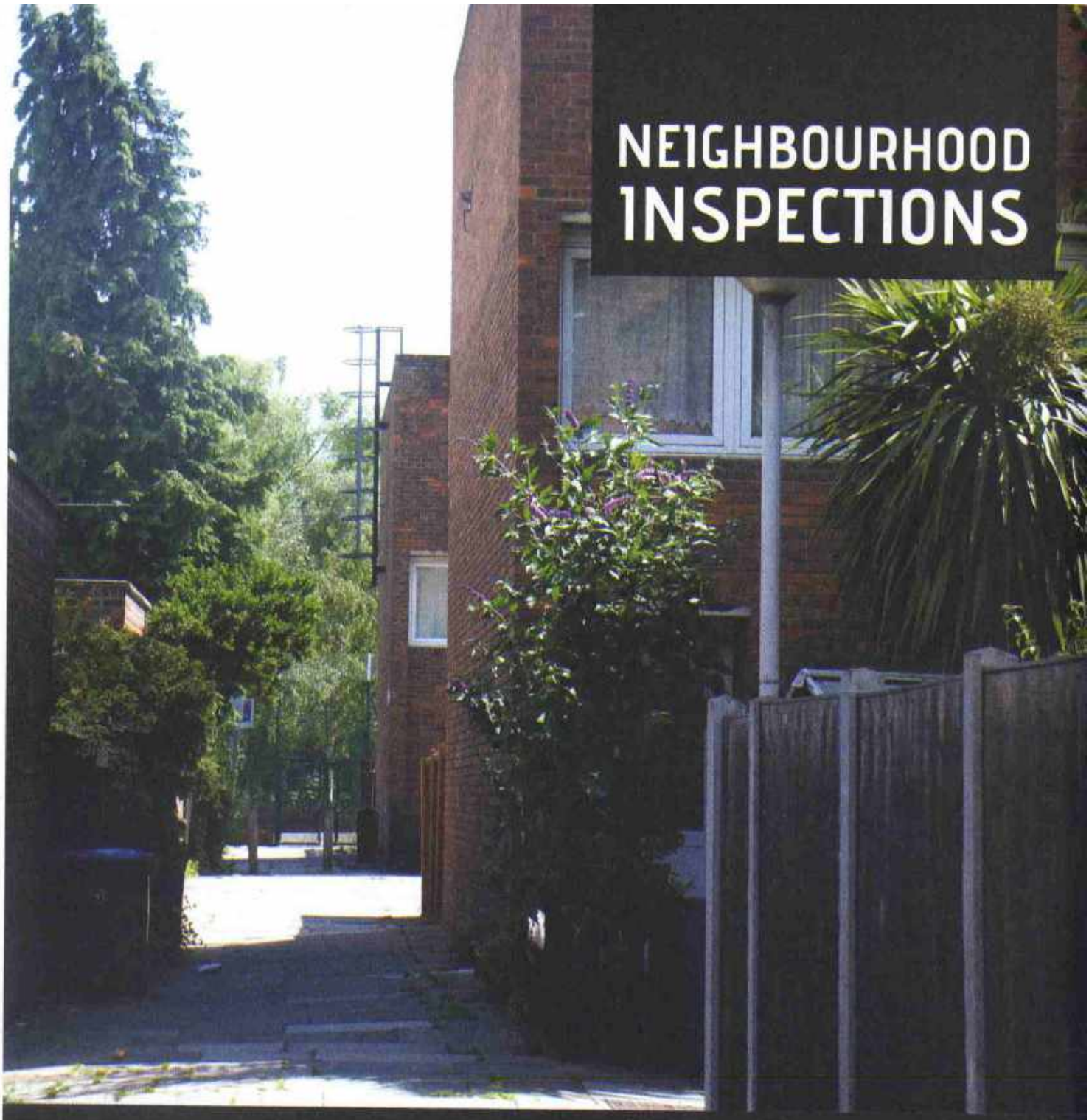
A flue in poor condition, combined with a boiler that is not working properly, could put you and your family in danger from carbon monoxide poisoning, which can cause death or serious injury.

If you have a boiler where all, or part of, the flue cannot be seen, you will need to arrange for inspection hatches to be fitted by 31 December 2012. This does not mean that your flue system is suddenly unsafe.

As long as the boiler passes a series of safety checks - including having audible carbon monoxide alarms fitted - it can be used normally for the time being.

If your boiler is situated on an outside wall, it is unlikely you have this type of flue. Alternatively, if your engineer can see all of the flue, you will not need to take any further action.

To find out more about the regulations and what to do next visit www.gassaferegister.co.uk/advice or call 0800 408 5500.

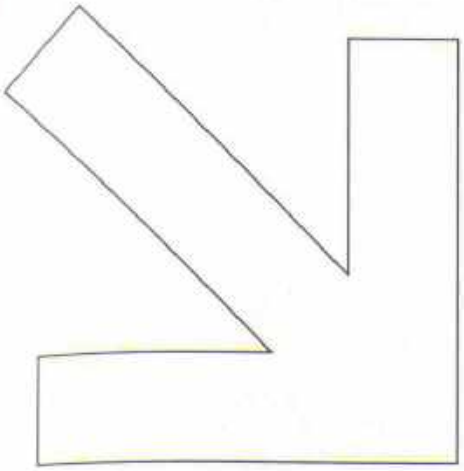


NEIGHBOURHOOD INSPECTIONS

Join our Wardens at the next Neighbourhood Inspection near you! You will be able to discuss issues in your area including:

- Graffiti
- Littering
- Dog fouling
- Unmaintained gardens
- Abandoned vehicles

If your neighbourhood isn't listed here but you'd like the Wardens to visit, call us on 0300 123 1237. If you live in a flat your caretaker will inspect the areas inside your block - just chat to them if you have any issues.



TUESDAY 17 APRIL 2012 - BROADWATERS
Meet Chris Waite at the junction between Whinchat Road and Wigeon Path at 2pm.

THURSDAY 19 APRIL 2012 - LESNES
Meet Steve Hayzen outside Clewer House, Wolvercote Road at 2pm.

TUESDAY 24 APRIL 2012 - MOORINGS
Meet Phil Briggs at the junction between Titmuss Avenue and Booth Close at 2pm.

THURSDAY 3 MAY - OLD CHURCH COURT
Meet Frank Smith by the entry gate to the car park at 2pm.

TUESDAY 8 MAY 2012 - MANORWAY
Meet Chris Waite at the junction between Goldcrest Close and Whimbrel Close at 2pm.

THURSDAY 17 MAY 2012 - SOUTHMERE
Meet Steve Hayzen at the junction between Hartslock Drive and Portmeadow Walk at 2pm.

TUESDAY 22 MAY 2012 - WATERFIELD
Meet Phil Briggs at the junction between Byron Close and Owen Close at 2pm.

TUESDAY 12 JUNE 2012 - BROADWATERS
Meet Chris Waite at the junction between Whinchat Road and Wigeon Path at 2pm.

THURSDAY 14 JUNE 2012 - GREENMEAD
Meet Steve Hayzen at Lime Row near the Post Office at 2pm.

TUESDAY 19 JUNE 2012 - MOORINGS
Meet Phil Briggs at the junction between Titmuss Avenue and Booth Close at 2pm.

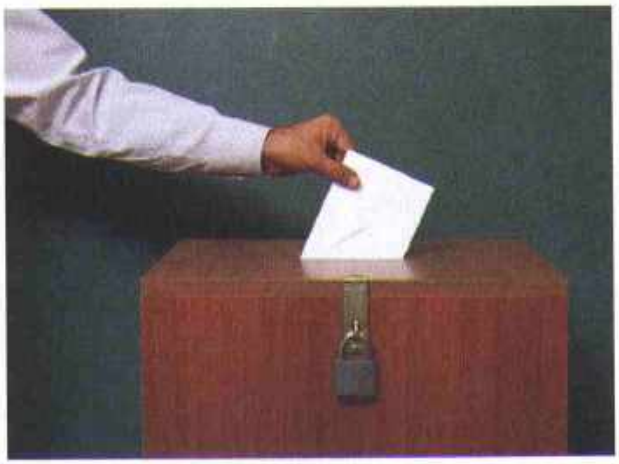
THURSDAY 21 JUNE 2012 - CRAYFORD
Meet Frank Smith at 2pm. Call us on 0300 123 1237 to find out where to meet.

THURSDAY 28 JUNE 2012 - ST JOSEPHS
Meet Frank Smith in the car park area at 2pm.

Don't forget to vote!

The next election for Mayor of London will be on 3 May 2012. From April 2012 the Mayor will have overall responsibility for housing in London, including how it is funded so don't miss your chance to vote.

The deadline to register to vote in the election is midnight on Wednesday 18 April 2012. You will need to contact your local council to add your name to the electoral register.



Resident satisfaction survey

In the coming weeks we will be sending out a resident satisfaction survey to find out what you think of our services and where you live. The questionnaire will be sent to approximately half of our residents, who will be chosen at random.

If you receive the survey please fill it in - it's your chance to tell us what's important to you and to influence the services you receive. There will be a prize draw with vouchers to be won too.

£20 voucher up for grabs!

The Gallions Residents Group (GRG) is currently looking at how Gallions deals with customer service, equality and diversity and involvement opportunities for residents.

They would like your views to help them work out how well we are doing. Complete the survey at www.gallionsha.co.uk by 30 April 2012 and you could win a £20 shopping voucher.

If you don't have access to the internet we can post a survey to you - just call us on 0300 123 1237.

Great disability group



A Disability Group meets at Lakeview Court, Central Way, Thamesmead on the first Tuesday of every month between 2pm and 4pm. If you would like to meet new people and help improve services for the disabled in your area just come along.

For more information contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk

Free family training

We are working with Greenwich Community College to offer families free learning and training opportunities.

There are a range of fun courses including: Spanish, French, arts and crafts, computer skills, fashion and textiles and jewellery making.

Contact Kelly Sullivan on 0300 123 1237 or email ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk if you would like to take part.



And the award goes to...

We have recently been awarded Excellence in Communities for the second year in succession.

The award, run by Quality Housing Services, judges our services against a comprehensive set of eight criteria including how we manage anti-social behaviour and how we encourage residents to get more involved in the local community.

We have also been recognised by Best Companies as 'Ones to Watch'; having narrowly missed out on 'The Sunday Times 100 best places to work in the not for profit sector' list.



KidsView WORDSEARCH

To celebrate the Queen's Diamond Jubilee we have hidden the names of six jewels in this wordsearch. Find them all and you could win a DVD pack.



Q	R	W	R	E	V	R	L	R	A	E	P	U
H	R	J	F	K	G	L	H	P	J	O	V	I
H	G	N	F	B	D	G	S	T	F	R	Z	X
K	D	L	U	M	S	N	T	B	E	V	K	C
E	T	H	M	E	M	E	R	A	L	D	A	A
R	Y	W	P	E	R	R	U	T	I	Y	O	U
I	C	J	K	K	E	L	B	P	L	O	Y	I
H	B	F	N	D	M	S	Y	A	Z	Z	J	X
P	C	L	N	M	E	N	O	A	L	V	H	C
P	J	L	H	Y	G	I	P	R	D	L	S	A
A	L	W	B	E	C	O	P	A	L	Y	S	U
S	N	J	E	K	T	L	A	P	D	O	U	I
G	T	F	I	D	N	S	A	O	Z	P	X	H

- ✓ RUBY
- ✓ OPAL
- ✓ EMERALD
- ✓ SAPPHIRE
- ✓ TOPAZ
- ✓ PEARL

This competition is just for kids under 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Glover, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 11 May 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name: .....

Parent's name: .....

Address: .....

.....

Telephone: .....

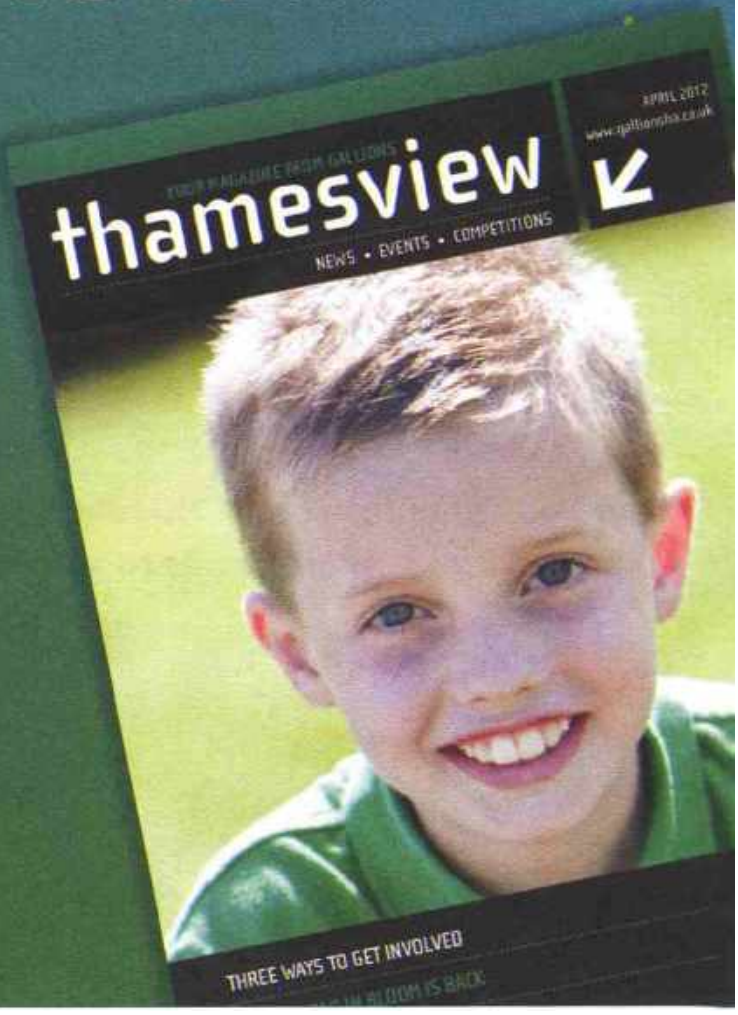
Well done to Ivan of Lensbury Way who was the winner of our last competition.

£30 shopping voucher to be won

Tell us what you think of thamesview...

We need your feedback and views to help us make your magazine even better. Complete and return this questionnaire and you could win a £30 shopping voucher.

Contact Anita Glover on 0300 123 1237 if you have any problems completing this form, or would like to discuss your comments in more detail.



Gallions Housing Association

Your Details

Name:

Address:

Contact Number:

Email address:

About Thamesview

1. **Do you read Thamesview magazine?** Yes ☐ No ☐
2. **Do you find Thamesview informative?** Yes ☐ No ☐
3. **Do you find Thamesview easy to understand?** Yes ☐ No ☐
4. **Do you find the layout easy to follow?** Yes ☐ No ☐
5. **How would you rate it overall?**

   Very good ☐ Good ☐ Poor ☐

6. **What is your favourite section?**

7. **Do you read Tenants' View?** Yes ☐ No ☐

   (the section written by residents)

8. **What do you think about Tenants' View?**

   Very good ☐ Good ☐ Poor ☐

9. **Do you have any suggestions about Thamesview or Tenants' View?**

If you'd like to receive Thamesview by email please send your name, address and email details to aglover@gallionsha.co.uk.

Thank You!
We really appreciate the time you have taken to complete this questionnaire.

Please return to: Anita Glover, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB by 18th May 2012.

Gallions Housing Association